

MERIDIAN FORGE / ANALYST DOCUMENT · WEEK 02

Business Case Recommendation

QA Control Review Business Case Recommendation · Revision 7661

QA Control Review · A recommendation for the sponsor

1. Need, value and scope

Proposed project

Develop a traceable record that QA and Engineering can use to investigate the MR-17 and QA cell incident further. This record should provide Operations with a basis that can justify their requests for later work. The investigation should not exceed \$3,000 worth of internal staff time over ten days, else the budget must be reviewed by the sponsor. [Mara Ilyan P.O. Manager, Operations Call] W

Business need

Develop a traceable record that QA and Engineering can use to investigate the MR-17 and QA cell incident further. This record should provide Operations with a basis that can justify their requests for later work. -W02-S01

Expected value and beneficiaries

The current value is information that will give QA and Engineering a traceable record they can use to investigate further, and give Operations a defensible basis for requesting later work. [W02-S-01] There is no current measurement for production value.

Included work

Deliverables as outlined in W02-S03:

- 1 command-ownership record
- 1 scheduling/retirement control inventory
- 1 evidence preservation checklist

These deliverables will ensure that we concretely identify where there are currently unknown owners or missing evidence.

The deliverables will be achieved as follows:

QA requests a record; the relevant custodian locates it; QA and Engineering check its origin and

meaning; Operations receives a summary.

Excluded work

The QA Control Review will exclude any decisions regarding the operation or replacement of the MR-17 unit, modifications to current software or records, and any operations beyond the cell referenced in the affected QA cell incident. [W02-S03]

2. Feasibility and limits

Technical feasibility

The tools are readily available but the requested read-only records have not been approved for access yet. [W02-S04]

Operational feasibility

QA must be available at the start to request the record.. The relevant custodian must be available to locate the requested records. Both QA and Engineering must be available to check the record's origin and meaning after receiving it from the custodian. Operations must be available at the end of the process to receive the summary.

Cost and resource feasibility

Per the estimates listed in W02-S05 - not including equipment purchases, software licenses or overtime - the base estimate is \$180 below the \$3,000 envelope; the upper estimate is \$525 above it.

Schedule feasibility

The 8-day business plan as introduced in W02-S04 could grant 2 days of headroom with respect to the 10-day limit. The 8-day plan is dependent on the arrival of exported records no later than day 3 and on the QA shifts remaining under their current schedule.

Known constraints

The review must be done within eight business days. [W02-S04]

The available staff hours as provisioned in W02-S04:

- The Analyst is available for 24 total hours across the 8 days
- Engineering is available for 12 total hours starting from day 4 onward
- QA is available 8 total hours within days 5-7
- Operations is available for 4 total hours across days 1 and 8

Risks and assumptions

The capacity to remain within the time constraints of the proposed project primarily hinges on the timely delivery of the requested record exports no later than by day three. There is no current confirmation of a delivery date for the exports [W02-S04]

QA must be available to review the records with Engineering. While the current availabilities allow for both to overlap between days 5-7, a shift reassignment could interrupt the available overlap between the departments.

3. Recommendation and next decision

Success measures and evidence

The success of the QA Control Review will produce three deliverables:

1. A command-ownership record
2. A scheduling/retirement control inventory for tests
3. An evidence-preservation checklist

Nia (QA) and Elias (Engineering) will have reviewed the source references and summarized them for Operations to make further work decisions. [W02-S05]

Nia reported that the first assessment of records produced 2/6 successful custodian identification and source links from a retrieval effort worth 60 minutes of staff minutes. [W02-S02]

The value of this review can be compared to the baseline assessment in terms of the relationship between staff minutes invested and successful custodian identification/original source link. It would be further useful to convert the staff minutes into money values as staffing cost, so that the percentage of useful findings will reveal the actual monetary value of the investigation.

Recommendation

revise

Rationale and conditions

I recommend that before proceeding with this QA Control Review, we first confirm the availability and staffing costs of the custodians.

Per W02-S03, custodians are the critical bridge between the record request and the source review. At this time, we are assuming that the exported documents will be delivered by day 3 of the review, but we do not yet have a confirmation on custodian availability in the W02-S04 schedule. Their availability will affect export delivery times.

Furthermore, custodians also form part of the internal staff and will need to be compensated for their

time, but are not currently accounted for in the base estimates listed in W02-S05. As the estimate currently stands, there are only \$180 of internal staff time available before \$3,000 planning envelope is reached. If the cost of custodians exceeds what is available, the sponsor must review the numbers first.

Next authorization or information step

Mara, the Operations Manager, must confirm the aforementioned details with the custodian department.

Source packet

W02-S01 · Request for a bounded review — Mara Ilyan · Production Operations Manager

W02-S02 · Evidence-retrieval workload — Nia Voss · Night QA Supervisor

W02-S03 · Proposed scope and current workflow — Mara Ilyan with Nia Voss · Review draft

W02-S04 · Capacity, access and operating limits — Elias Chen · Robotics Systems Engineer

W02-S05 · Estimate and success-measure sheet — Mara Ilyan · Planning estimate, not a quote

All case records and figures are fictional teaching data. This report does not authorize spending or operating equipment. The instructor evaluates the reasoning; completed fields are not a grade.